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Subject: [External] AI Action Plan
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Removing copyright protection barriers that prevent OpenAI from scraping data indiscriminately opens the door to serious abuse and disastrous ramifications for society in general. If an artist has uploaded their work, the LLM consumes that data, and users begin to generate content "in the style of" that artist- how is that creator meant to defend ownership over their brand? Already people are uploading their own "Rihanna" albums and generating "Indiana Jones" movies to post on YouTube. Branded content will become impossible to control. Celebrities will be unable to choose how their likenesses are used. And stepping away from the threat to business- the threat to you and your loved ones. Photos of yourself and people you know- children- can be scraped for use in pornography or to create fake videos and audio portraying events that never happened. Right now, however, you own the photos you take. You currently have recourse because copyright automatically goes to the owner. But removing those protections opens the floodgates to malicious actors stealing your personal material, and every other thing you've ever posted in your online history.

Can't you see evidence of the lawless Wild West already in the making on the internet? Google image results are saturated with fake images, and misinformation is becoming harder and harder for the average person to spot. Children in schools are failing in critical thinking. As the internet fills up with AI generated material, and it begins to scrape itself over and over, we will end up with a database of nonsense, a xerox of a xerox. What we Americans need is a recourse against actors like OpenAI. Force them to cease scraping copywritten data and give us the option to take our data back- something like the DMCA. Halt the takeover until our lawmakers can plan out a safe and fair future with AI technology.

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